WEEK 3 · LECTURE L3 OF 3 · UNIT I

The Ethics and Culture of Adoption

Consent, surveillance, the digital divide, and the Round 1 debrief.

Part 1	Consent at work, monitoring and the divide
Part 2	The DPDP Act 2023 and imported tools
Part 3	Round 1 debrief across pods, and a preview of Round 2
Read	Manuti and de Palma (2018), Chapters 3 and 6; DPDP Act 2023 orientation note

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THE TURN OF THE HOUR

The warehouse that answers your question is the same warehouse that watches your people.

You cannot build one without the other. Individual-level records, joined across systems and kept over time, are the precondition for people analytics *and* the definition of a surveillance capability. The only question ever available is how it is governed.

ETHICS OF ADOPTION

Consent at work is not consent in a shop

Valid consent is informed, specific, and **freely given**. The employment relationship weakens all three, and the third most of all.

Power asymmetry

A person who can be appraised, promoted or released by the party asking is not in a position to refuse comfortably.

Bundling

Consent buried in an onboarding pack, alongside things that genuinely are conditions of employment, is not specific to anything.

Purpose drift

Data given for one purpose becomes a feature in a model built two years later. Consent was for the first use, never the second.

No real exit

If declining means losing access to payslips, leave requests or the roster, the choice is nominal.

What to do instead of leaning on consent

Narrow the collection, state the purpose in words a frontline employee would use, set a retention period and honor it, and give a real route to query or correct. **Design so that consent is not doing work it cannot bear.**

ETHICS OF ADOPTION

Where measurement becomes monitoring

Rung	Example in an HR stack	What changes at this step
Aggregate, historical	Department attrition by quarter	Nobody is identifiable. Uncontroversial.
Individual, historical	One person's training record and appraisal history	Normal HR administration, and long accepted.
Individual, behavioral	Login times, session length, message volume	The record is now of conduct rather than of outcomes. Presence becomes a proxy for effort.
Individual, inferential	A flight-risk score attached to a named employee	A prediction about the future becomes part of the present record — and can act on the person before the event.
Continuous, ambient	Location, keystrokes, camera, sentiment	Observation without a stated occasion. The employee cannot know when they are not being read.

No single step feels like a decision. **Each is a small extension of the one before, and the step from rung three to rung four is usually taken by an analyst, not by a board.**

ETHICS OF ADOPTION

The divide, seen from the data side

Week 2 treated exclusion as a question about who can use a system. There is a second consequence, and it runs the other way.

Excluded means unrecorded

People the systems do not reach generate no telemetry, complete no digital courses, answer no in-app surveys. They are absent from the evidence base by construction.

Unrecorded means unserved

Investment follows evidence. A group that generates no data generates no findings, so no business case is ever written for it, so it stays excluded.

Breaking the loop

Measure the gap deliberately — coverage as a metric in its own right — and gather evidence about the excluded by means that do not require the system they cannot use.

One tile worth putting on the dashboard

Coverage: what share of the workforce this system actually reaches, reported alongside every adoption or engagement figure. It is the honest denominator, and it names the people the rest of the dashboard cannot see.

L3 · DPDP ACT 2023 · ORIENTATION

What the law asks of an employer handling staff data

Principle	What it means at work
Notice and consent	Tell people what is collected and why. Consent must be free, specific, informed and clear.
Employment as a legitimate use	Section 7 lets an employer process data for employment purposes without fresh consent. It is not a license for any use.
Purpose limitation	Data collected for payroll should not quietly become data for monitoring or ranking.
Security and breach duty	Reasonable safeguards, and a duty to report a breach to the Data Protection Board and to each person affected.
Rights of the employee	Access, correction and erasure, and a way to raise a grievance.

THE LINK TO ROUND 4 An algorithm trained on employee data inherits every one of these duties.

L3 · ETHICS AND CULTURE

Imported tools carry imported assumptions

82%

Language

82% of GreenLeaf employees prefer a language other than English. Hindi alone is 35%.

48%

Device

48% are Smartphone only and about 8% have only a feature phone. A desktop portal misses them.

Self-service culture

Many tools assume an employee who has desk time, an email address and the confidence to act alone.

THE TEST

Before adopting any tool, list what it assumes about the user. Then check each assumption against Employee_Master.

TWO ROUNDS ARE IN. NOW WE NAME WHAT YOU DID.

You have already used all six frameworks

ROUND 1 — THE DIAGNOSIS

The option you played	The framework underneath it
1A Foundations First	Kavanagh — systems maturity
1B Analytics-First Leap	Bersin — analytics tiers
1C Mobile-First Equity Lens	The three-level digital divide
1D Regulatory Alignment	DPDP 2023 and the Code on Social Security
Every pod — the CFO challenge	Kotter — step 1, urgency

ROUND 2 — THE ARCHITECTURE

Every pod chose 2A, Modular HRMS Core. Every pod named the same System of Record. Zero variance on the headline choice.

Underneath it: between **one and seven** systems retired, and benefit–cost ratios from **0.375 to 1.07** on an identical cost.

The framework underneath 2A was Kavanagh again — Record, then Engagement, then Insight. Two pods named it. Two reached it without a citation.

Three pods diagnosed a **digital divide**. One diagnosed an **analytics deficit**. All four built the same architecture. **So was the diagnosis doing any work?** Hold that question through the hour.

PART 3 · LOOKING AHEAD

What Round 2 asks of your pod

The core choice

Suite or best of breed for the HRIS, and which system becomes the single record.

The sequence

Which modules, in what order, within ₹6 crore and the capacity to absorb change.

The deliverable

D1, the Maturity and Tech-Stack Blueprint, is built on your Round 1 and Round 2 work.

CARRY FORWARD Your Round 1 diagnosis should decide your Round 2 architecture. If it does not, one of them is wrong.

Three things to carry out of this room

1

Ask who is missing before you ask what the number says.

Selection, not sampling error, is what breaks HR data. If the absent people are absent for a reason connected to your question, the file cannot answer it.

2

A metric is an agreement; a dashboard is a set of incentives.

Six questions make a definition, and choosing what to display is choosing what the organization will optimize — including in ways nobody intended.

3

Analytics and surveillance are one capability.

Consent cannot carry the ethical weight in an employment relationship. Narrow collection, state purpose, limit retention, report coverage.

READING AND BRIDGE

Where to read this, and what follows

In the readings folder

Angrave et al., *HR and analytics: why HR is set to fail the big data challenge* (Unit-3 Core) · Fitz-enz & Mattox on predictive analytics · the DPDP Act 2023 · your Unit teaching note on People Analytics.

Not filed — this session is your source

Goodhart's law and the measurement-gaming literature · the workplace-surveillance debate. Kellogg, Valentine & Christin on algorithmic control (Unit-3 Core) is the closest filed text and is worth reading now rather than later.

Practice

Take one number you quoted in your Round 1 rationale. State its population, its denominator, and who is missing from it. Then say whether the claim still stands.

Coming next

Unit II — the architecture: HRIS as system of record, the ATS, the LMS, and the integration layer that decides whether any of them speak.

The fairness audit of predictive models comes in Unit III, and everything on the surveillance ladder returns there with a real model to examine.